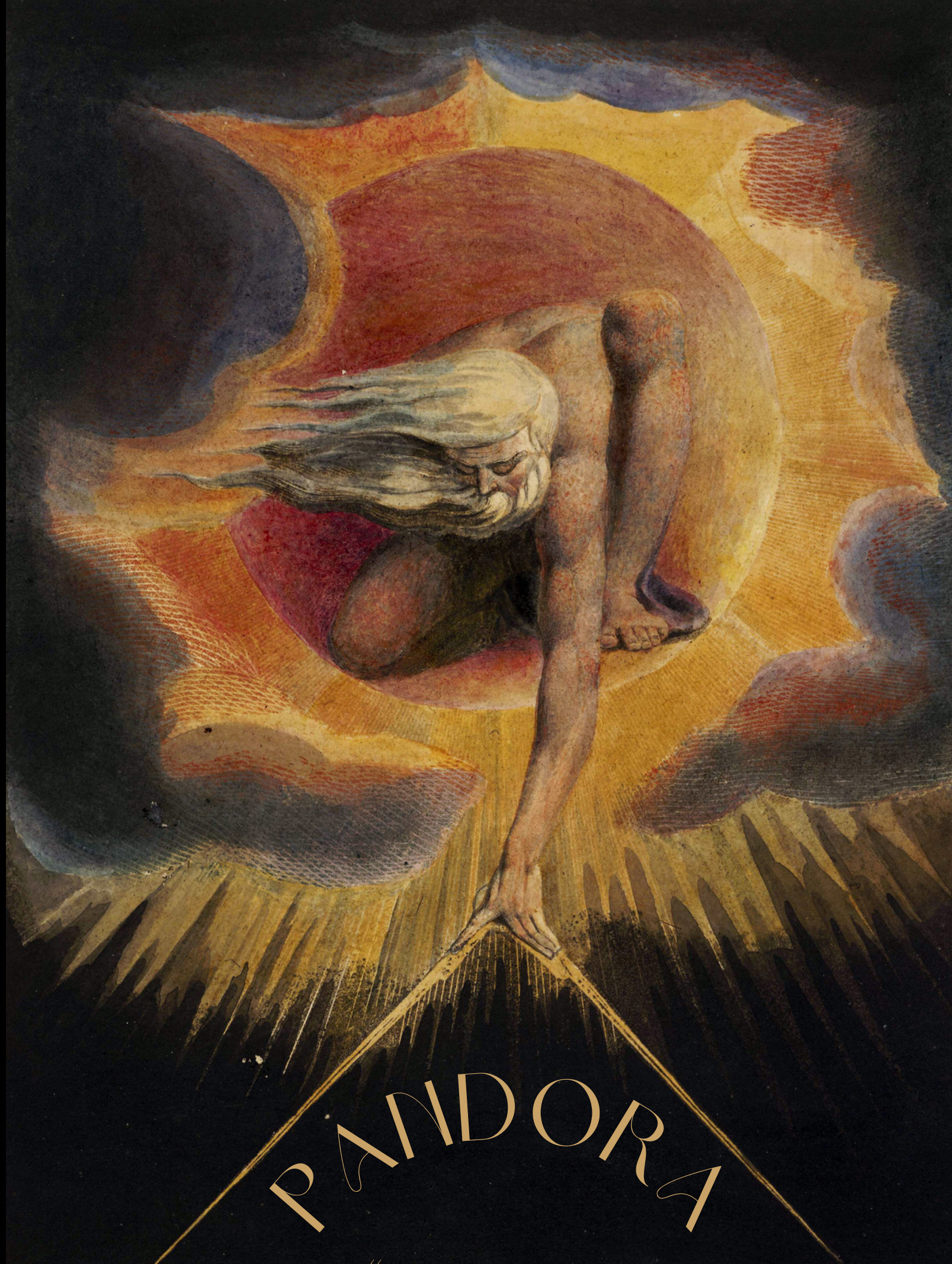




PANDORA

ISSUE 1

“EN ARCHE”

12/24

Contents



Robert Ken Hanke
Panagiotis Kouremenos
David A.
Randall
Stergios

Design
Writing
Editing
Interview
Website

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Pandora Magazine Issue 1: “En Arche...”

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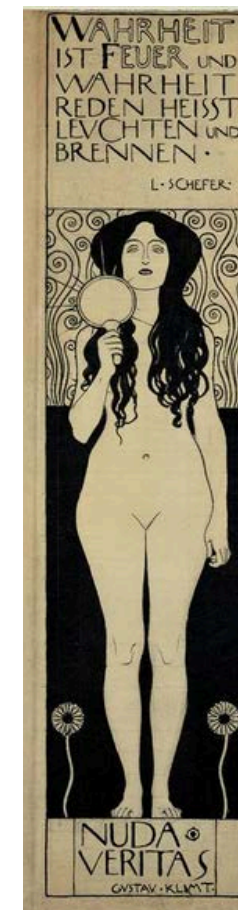
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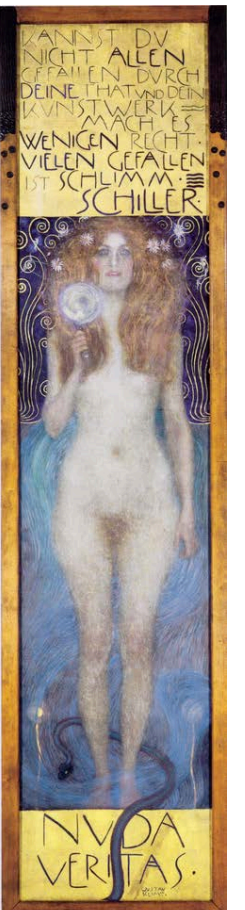
Manifesto



Our magazine is a project which culminated from our inherent need to converse about art and to dedicate a piece of us to its grandeur. After many failed or abandoned projects, the seeds that were planted all these years only made us more and more obsessed with its sublime nature and her secret, which has been revealed only to a few. Through our humble efforts, we hope to reflect even a slight ray of the light art shines on our world. We hope that through our volumes and issues the readers will find the missing part that made their lives feel incomplete and meaningless.



Maybe they find shelter in our poetry, our photographs, our paintings and the things we want to say, or even take inspiration to create something bigger than themselves. We see art as an act of self-renovation, an uprising against the monotone ways of everyday life, an appreciation of glistening beauty, unbothered by the passage of time, but also we want to affirm ourselves that we are capable. Capable of creating, of recreating, finding something in places that are empty and alone. We also want to show the public artists and writers whose works had never had the luck to be seen or enjoyed in the world.



Subscriptions are not needed here, this is purely a hobby that is being done with much, much love. Our ethos lies in what life has taught us about art and what art has taught us about life. We hope that this magazine offers you, dear reader, something that will stick with you, to help you bear the inescapable dread of life. We hope the contents of this magazine mend your aching.





When I was young, I saw an almond tree's petal fall to the ground and follow a cold water's river. Idle and indifferent, I watched it tread along the currents, for I was a child. The second time I visited the same place, on a walk and an escape from a winter evening's winter and storm, I found solace in the exact same image that was presented to me years before. It presented itself to me and I found within it a new meaning. It was a warmth much needed. I think of art as endless, boundless and timeless. Fostered in nature, rooted in man's life. Well-kept and pristine, art is shaped and thrust to life from its maker's inner world.



Separation II by Edvard Munch; 1896; lithograph

When making art, I feel its warmth in my viscera, it flows through my veins. Upon it I extend and base my faith. I declare myself upon art's pedestal and serve its purpose with respect and love. And so, the flame comforts and guides me like a light. It lets me prosper, guards me with a truth that once I accept it, I am beacons in the sea of life's turmoil. Once I turn to dust, I hope for my creations to echo in the corridors of time, as they too will fade eventually like an age of gold does. Like a saint, art saves me. I celebrate and honor it.



Hello, my name is Rob and first and foremost I am a fan of all forms of art. The way humans express themselves has always fascinated me since I was a child. Just having the ability to transform an idea or feeling into a work of art is truly a beautiful gift. In a sense, the creation of something new, that can potentially outlive us, connects mankind to God and the universe. I found painting to be the best way for me to do that, because it gives me the most freedom and it also feels the closest to my heart. Occasionally I try myself in other art mediums, such as writing, photography, sculpture and design. Being part of this magazine with so many talented artists is a dream come true and I hope you enjoy reading it, as much as we enjoyed making it.



Marsh landscape II by Robert Ken Hanke
2024; acrylic on paper





My name is David and my main contributions to the collective involve writing, illustrating, collage work, graphic design, editing and music reviewing. I find art to be a very important factor in human life, as fundamental to our anatomy as is the heart. Art at its very core is an endeavor of creation and creation is a triumph. I believe that the definition of existence is purpose, and in art, our creations yield purpose through the beauty in our expressions. Art isn't just a task or a career, art is an abstract, intangible, invisible force that flows through all of nature the same way fate and gravity do.



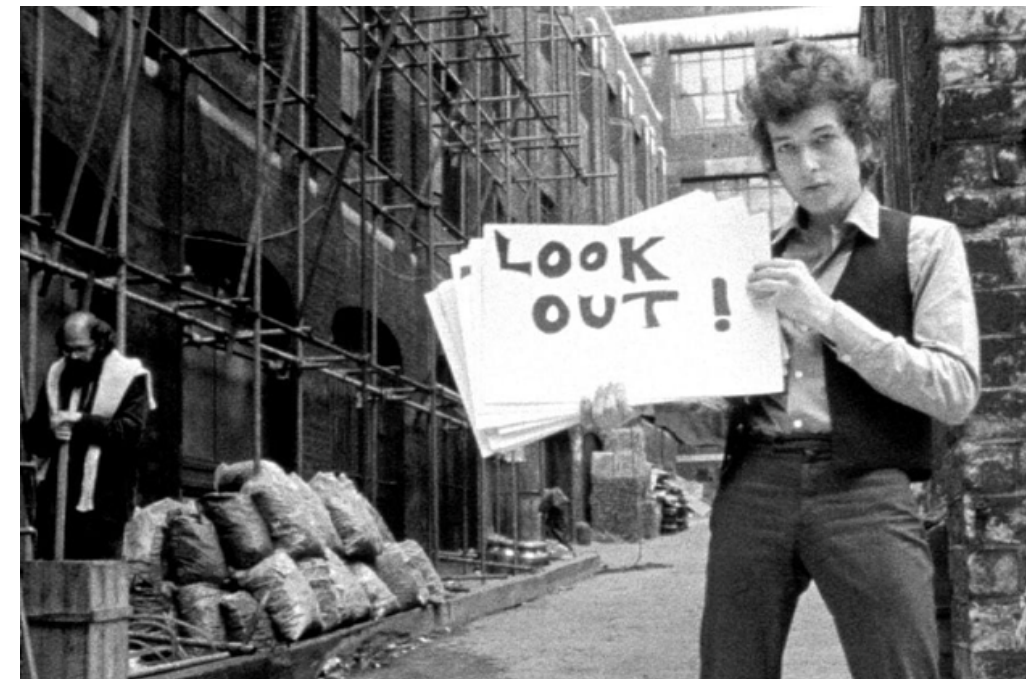
Venus and Adonis by Maerten de Vos

Date unknown; oil on panel

Art allows us to play Prometheus and create compelling stories molded from our very brain waves and yet it grounds us to our fleshy bodies. The rejection of art is the rejection of humanity. I respect art as though it is a tree that bears fruit for me to consume when I tend to it. That's why I'm in this collective, because this is a demonstration, a celebration of art for the world.



I'm Stergios, the web developer of the team and a novice photographer. Writing this introduction was an unexpectedly delicate endeavor, as I grappled with capturing what art means to me, the non-artist among artists. Describing myself wasn't easy either. I instinctively sifted through years of candid photos, the unserious kind, searching for the thread that could weave together my recent past. Looking back, I've done a lot, yet nothing constant enough to be summed up here. It turns out that it's quite challenging to define who you are without any prompts. That's where art comes in—the one unwavering element in my life. After Dylan showed me that music transforms when you really listen, I came to understand what should have been obvious: art is expression. Since then, I've been on a constant quest for connections—in lyrics, poems, paintings, photographs, films, video game dialogue, and everything in between—seeking that brief “this guy gets it” moment. Inspired by De Beauvoir, I concluded that life is an elusive collection of moments, hard to define but best told through the art that echoes alongside them. Through the ebbs and flows, with a new playlist for each journey, half-read books strewn about, an indie game library and films my friends stream over Discord, each part of my identity can be summarized by art. So, that's me: a tapestry of favorite songs and blurry photos on my phone.



**Untitled
(Subterranean
Homesick Blues
Still) by D.A.
Pennebaker
1965; film still /
documentary
footage**





My name is Joël and through photography and writing I try to capture the essence of something long forgotten, dear to us, that has always been there, deep down in our human consciousness. In order to express that, I try to experiment with different media. So far, those media are mainly poetry and photography, but for now my focus lies more on photography. I am mainly interested in subjects that in some way or another have traces of age or are connected to the mundane, since I am convinced that in everyday life lies the deepest poetry (which also includes visual poetry). We have strayed away from being impressed by the real world that God gave us and now are more impressed by its imitation (poetry or more broadly, art). I try to negotiate this dichotomy between the real world and its representation through my art.



Isakovo by Joël Miguel Lädrach
2024; digital photography



I'm Jaro, I write poetry and literary essays and sometimes short stories. As someone who loves philosophy and theology, I often use my art to digest and creatively connect different ideas I am interested in. Hence, I draw a lot on Christianity, ancient mythology and Platonism, but I'm also very interested in learning about other traditions. I am convinced of the enchanting presence of God in all things and find art to be a way to rediscover this beauty that is often lost. A further interest of mine is history and how art is shaped by its historical context.



Seaport by Moonlight by Claude Joseph Vernet
1771; oil on canvas

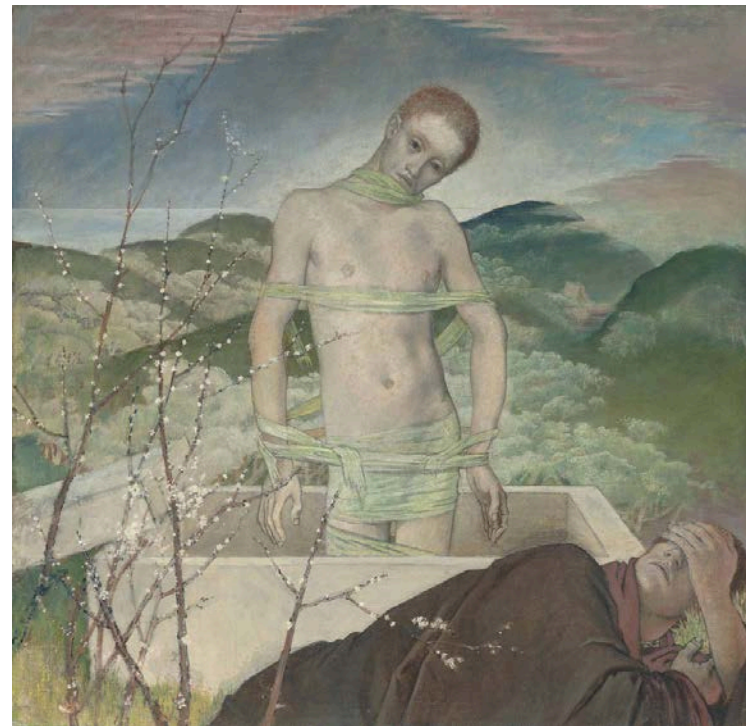


The Coronation of the Virgin by Tintoretto
1579; oil on canvas





Hey guys! My name is Michael and I'm currently a university student in the United States. My primary interests lie within art analysis, particularly the theory and historical context behind various art movements, what drives them, and how it influences target audiences. I also do the same for literature and find myself going after more erudite or experimental forms of it. I am currently in the early stages of making my own book, which I plan to begin this year.



Resurgam by Glyn Philpot
1929; oil on canvas



"The Demon (In the Cafe) by Wojciech Weiss
1904; oil on canvas



Over the last few years I've been working in video art, exploring the ways the digital camera in each of our pockets can and cannot capture light - the way it describes darkness differently than the eye - with alignment to ideas prominently from R. Bruce Elder and Birgit and Wilhelm Hein, along with filmmakers of structural and materialist filmmaking tradition: Michael Snow, Paul Sharits, Carl E. Brown etc. for a sort of digital-structuralist-materialist camera. For recent work: I have been working on a project since October 2023 - soon to be finished - focusing these ideas around a reconstruction of the Halloween franchise; where priorly they were applied to ideas of 'creating *home video*' and the ideas of Henri Bergson's 'intuitive form'. In the past I've worked heavily in mixed media painting. This culminated in a series of still lifes melding Chaïm Soutine and Alberto Burri (with a splash of Rothko), which may have laid the seeds for looking at the material rather than the subject. Additionally, I have great interest in literature and music, but find myself most occupied with film/video. I'm a huge fan of Woolf and Lispector! And for a fun fact, my favourite music right now is Pretty V, DJ Screw, Still House Plants, Mariah Carey, and I'll round it out with Beatrice Harrison. Thank you.



Halloween 14 by Jamie Daly; 2024; video art





Hey, my name is Robin Reimann, I'm a 19 year old multimedia artist from Germany. My focus lies on photography right now, but I also have a lot of fun with collages, writing poetry and documenting my life. I think artistically, but also just purely for myself, that is my greatest work. Most of my writing isn't public, but it will be sooner or later.

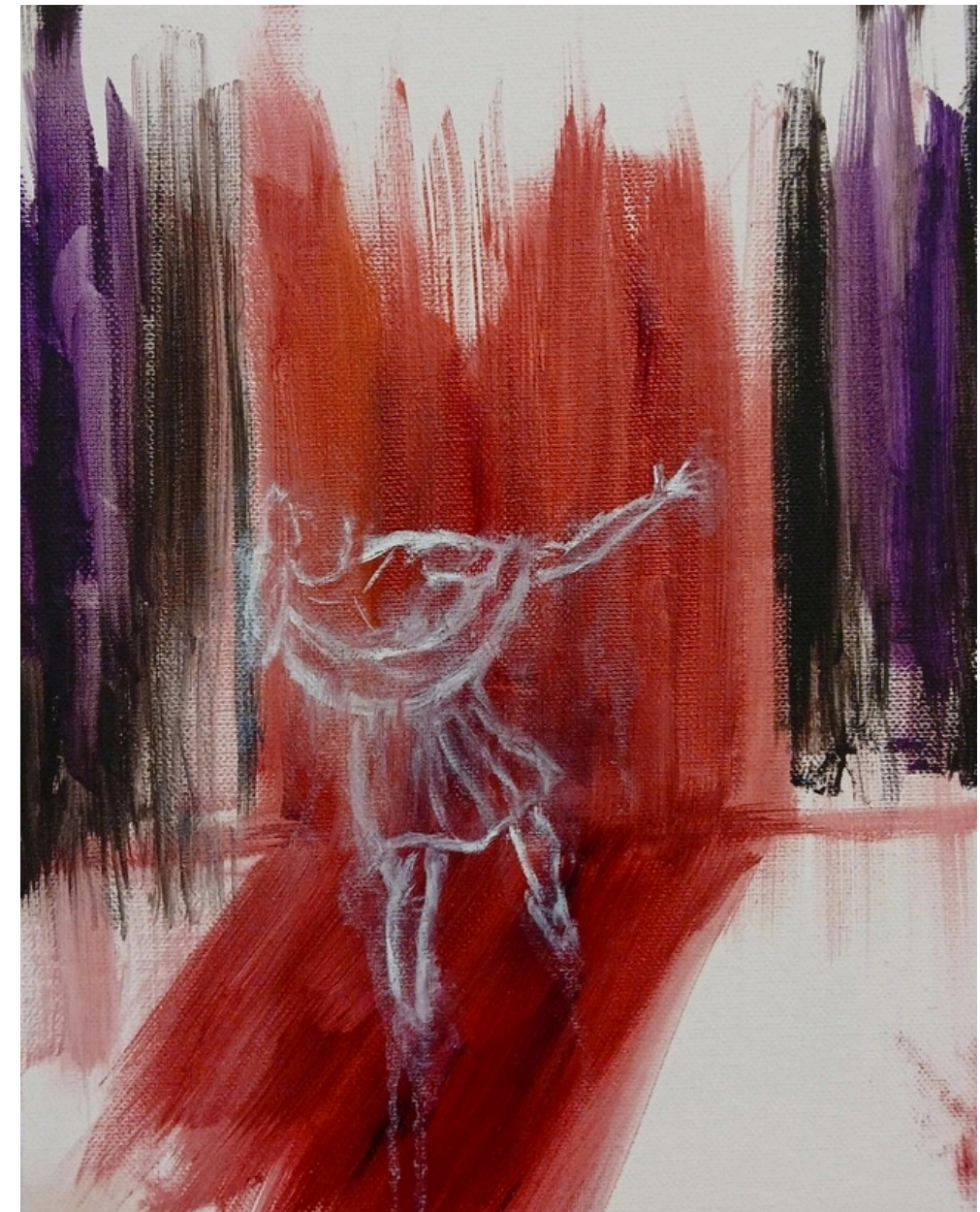


Untitled by Robin Reimann
2024; digital photography

I'm currently working on my first two photography books, I hope to come to a satisfying result within the next year for one of them. I'm also a huge fan of film, especially experimental cinema, I probably wouldn't have started my journey without it. Sadly, I couldn't bring myself to create a film I'm satisfied with yet.



Hi ! I am a fan of showing and not telling, does this mean I am a good artist ? No. Does this mean that I am not good at writing ? Yes. So, if not writing then what? Well, music and painting should be more than enough, I also started photographing people recently. I am also a hopeless extrovert, as one could say. That's all as far as I remember, ah yes, perhaps I shouldn't forget my name. Charilaos.

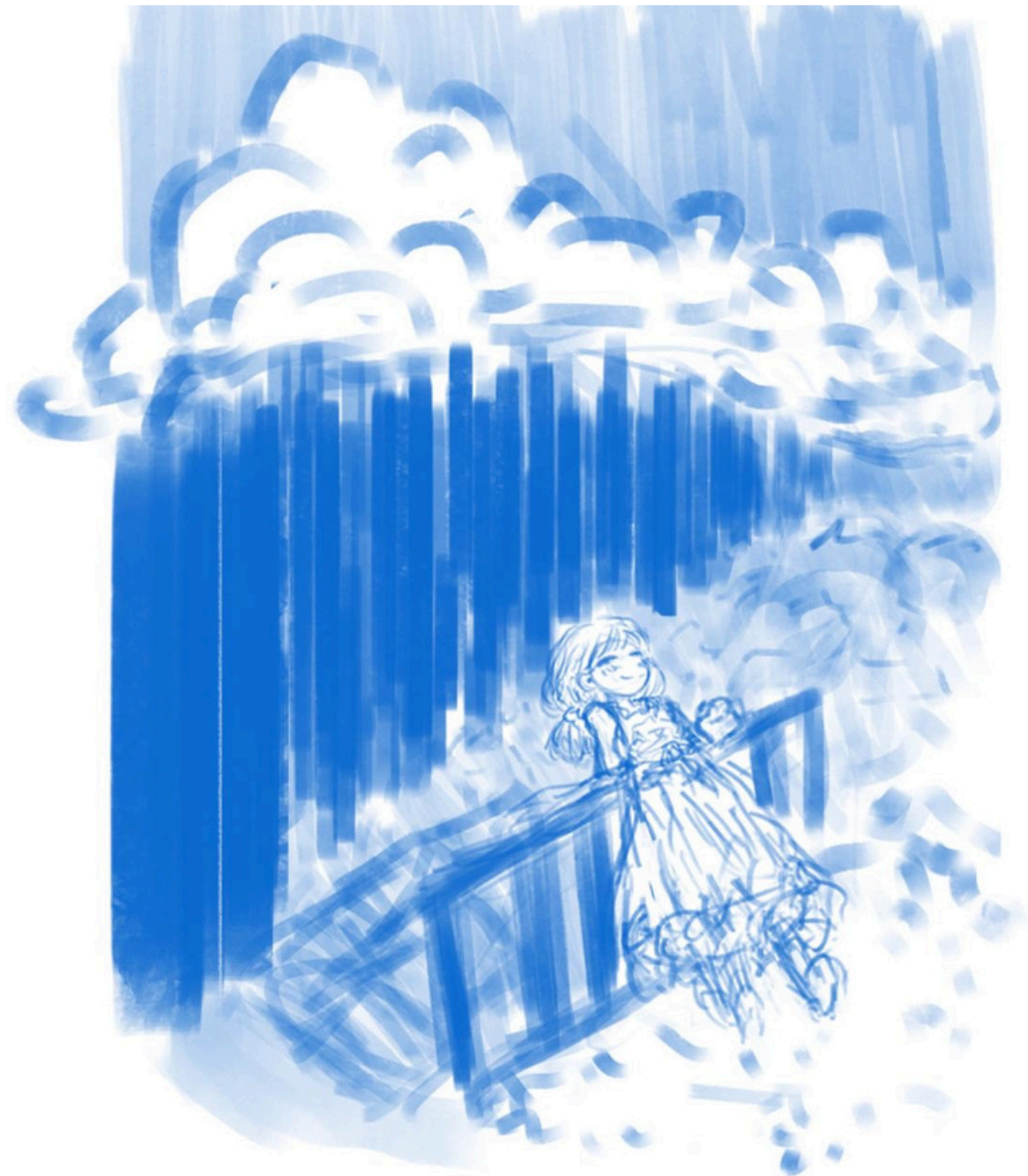


The Comedy of War by Charilaos
2023; oil on canvas





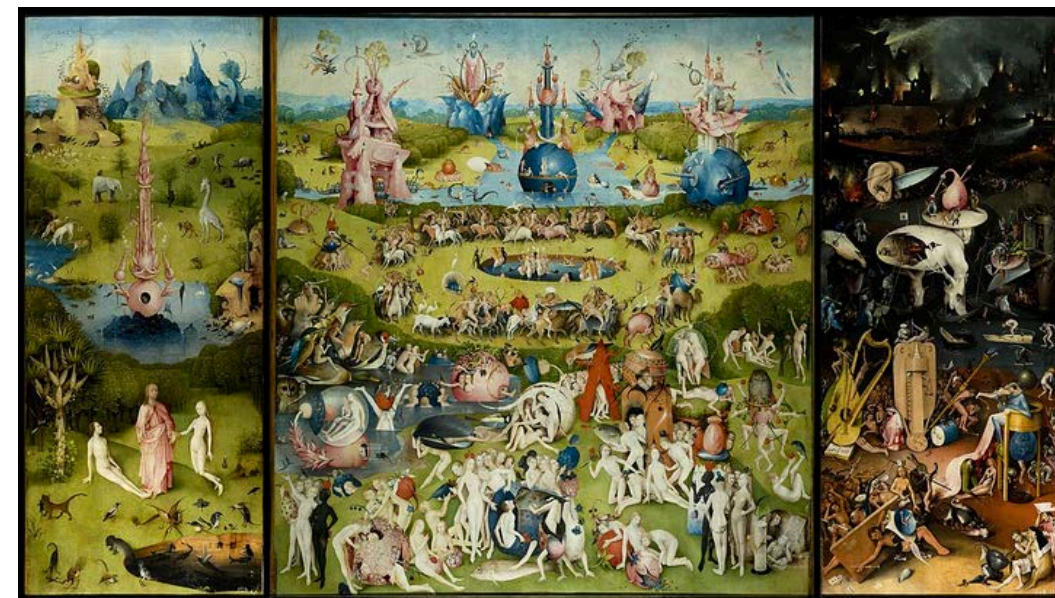
Hello, this is Mayoi, I do drawings and edits on photoshop, as well as writing whatever comes to mind on my notes app. Big fan of fun dialogue and intimacy in art of any medium; although I am still very much uneducated in a lot of things, I am willing to learn and read a lot! As of now I am a stubborn person when it comes to creation, but I hope I can still make use of it well.



Untitled by Mayoi
2024; photoshop



Born in 2005, even though, to be honest, it doesn't hold any significance from which time the author is; my first exposure to my keen interests of today came about when I first watched a show called "Super Hero Monkey Team Hyperforce Go", which was so terrifying to view, I am almost surprised I didn't take up smoking cigarettes and drinking beer when I was 7 years old; nevertheless, the spark was lit, although growing up in India wasn't easy, to put it lightly, but the fact of having such a vast history kinda forces you to notice the details, thus the real me was put into practice, whom I still cater to today, who juggled between his vision of conquering politics, engaging in athletic practices for the extremes of it and dissolving in artforms of any kind, like music, films, shows, games or the usual traditional notions of painting, photography etc. I am glad for the freedom of never having specifics, so I can live lives I couldn't in my own; as much as I would like to be some kind of jester, privileged for my love in a comedy of manners, the truth is that those are the things I hold so dear to myself, with all due respect to the noble institutions of science, which are the core for a transcendental future, the notions of faith, when applied to art, bring the sort of authenticity in nature, which no other could bring; even though I am not an orthodox of any religion, let alone religious, but principles, when not imposed, rather created for the sole reason to be perfect as GOD is, make up the only things valuable in such a materialistic world that oppresses its own kind, therefore, the trial of my life stands on me for uniting with the people of my kind so flourishing may prosper by serving a role.

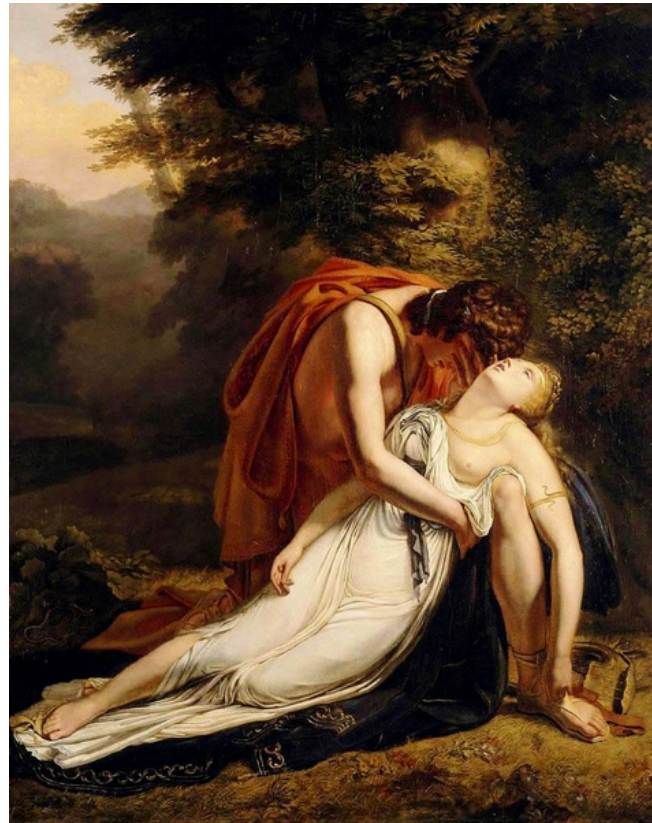


Garden of
Earthly
Delights by
Hieronymus
Bosch
1490- 1510;
Oil on oak
panel

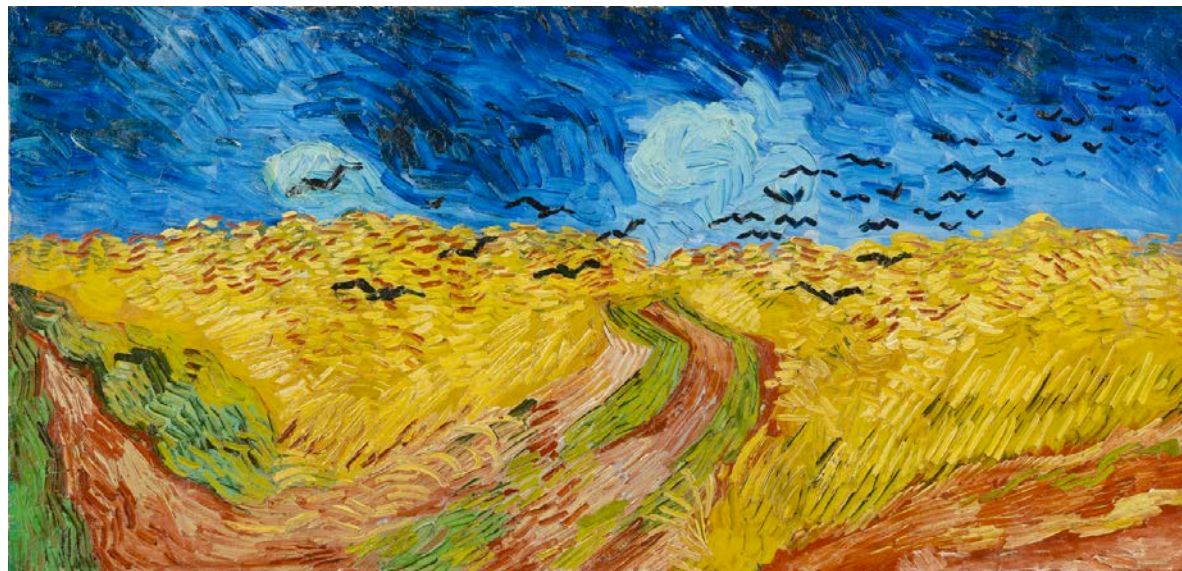




I'm May, not the month soaked in sunshine but quite close, not Artemis' companion either - though I often wish I was a nymph as a feather-light and barely visible as a forest fog. Another admirer of the arts, as a fetus I slipped and fell into a well brimming with ink. Since then, it won't unstain my hands, it manifests in the form of books I lay my eyes on or words I scatter on paper. Consumed by the contrasting subjects of death and love. The grim, abrupt end of one's life and the sort of love that makes the very deceased crawl out of their eternal homes, just to be embraced by familiar arms again. And so, for as long as existence continues to unravel its terrors and its delights, I will be letting the ink that nestled inside of me slither and drip.



Orpheus Mourning the Death of Eurydice by Ary Scheffer
1814; oil on canvas



Wheatfield with Crows by Vincent van Gogh
1890; oil on canvas



Art itself is the pseudo-existence of life and death in stasis. This magazine represents, to me, the pinnacle of this concept. Becoming part of this collective, interacting with other talented artists of all mediums, has helped realise where my poetry stands in this short interval. All the poets, with a date as a pin to their last piece; behind a curtain. Yet there are these respiring ghosts like me who dance with these apparitions. And like a stream coughs up reeds, among these many seeds Pandora is borne. Stories, as they perspire from the bodies of ideas, have shaped my life as a wall shapes vine; I hope that my presence within Pandora can become the wall - in which all is shaped after. On the back of paddling water I have grown; my name is Cameron McNaughton, and I intend for you to hear it.



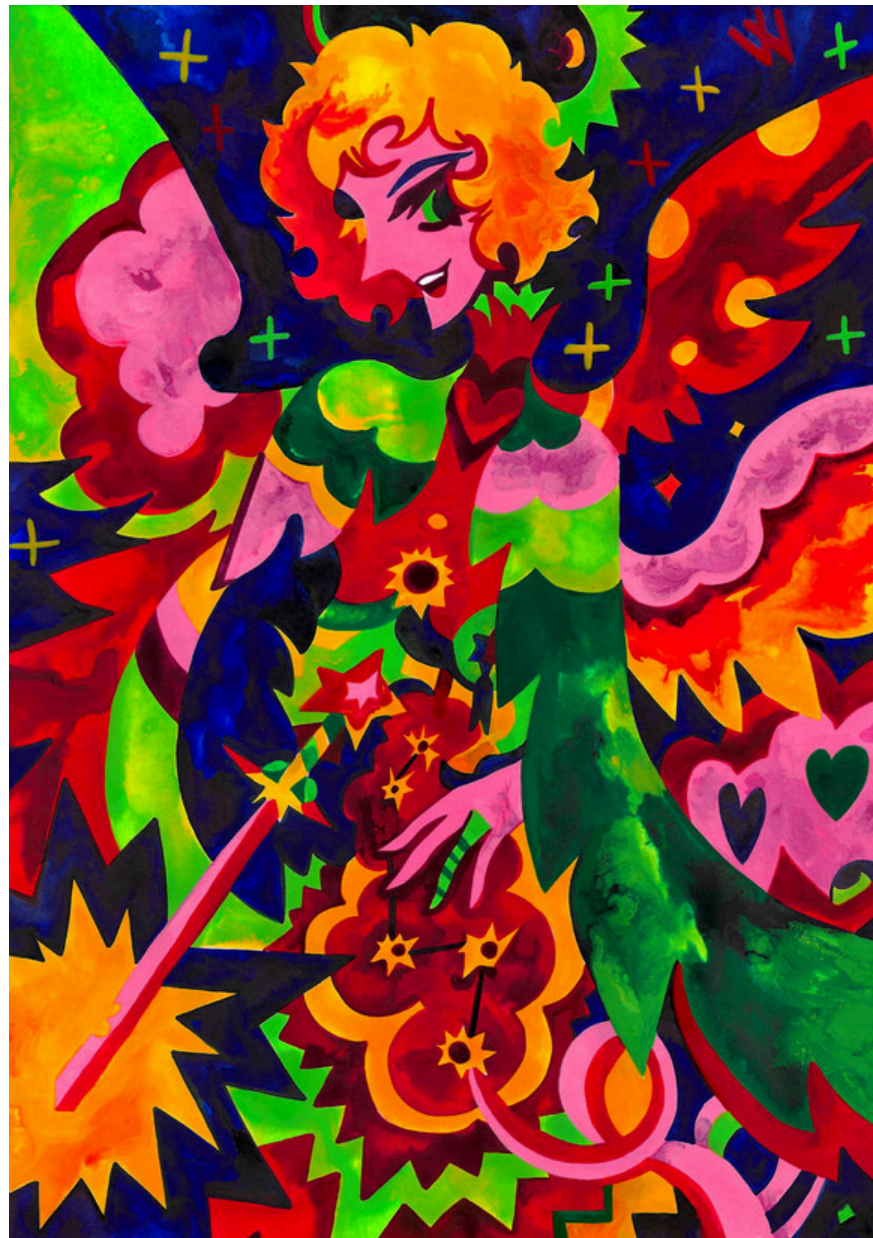
Volga Song by Wassily Kandinsky
1906; tempera on cardboard



Veronika - [@veronikapurplesfinx](#)



My name is Veronika, also known as Purplesfinx online! I really enjoy all kinds of fine arts, but my favourite mediums are illustration and literature. My passion is to create and explore the worlds that are different from our mundane, so you can always find the psychedelic and religious themes in my works (no drugs or cults, pure fantasy!). I escape to the stories I make and can spend hours crafting characters' adventures in my manga and written stories. I am a strong believer that colours can bring very strong positive emotions to our lives, so I always make sure to have fun with my palettes! Let's make the Wonderland the new norm!



Angelic by Veronika; 2021; watercolour on paper



Konstantinos Charisopoulos - [@xarisopoylosk](#)



My name is Konstantinos, and I am a visual artist based in Athens, Greece. Passionate about all art forms, I strive to blend different mediums, pushing the boundaries of versatility and innovation in my work. Art is an essential part of my life—a way to share my vision of the world, not merely as an expression of my emotions but as a means to explore deeper connections with my surroundings and to uncover meaning in every aspect of life.

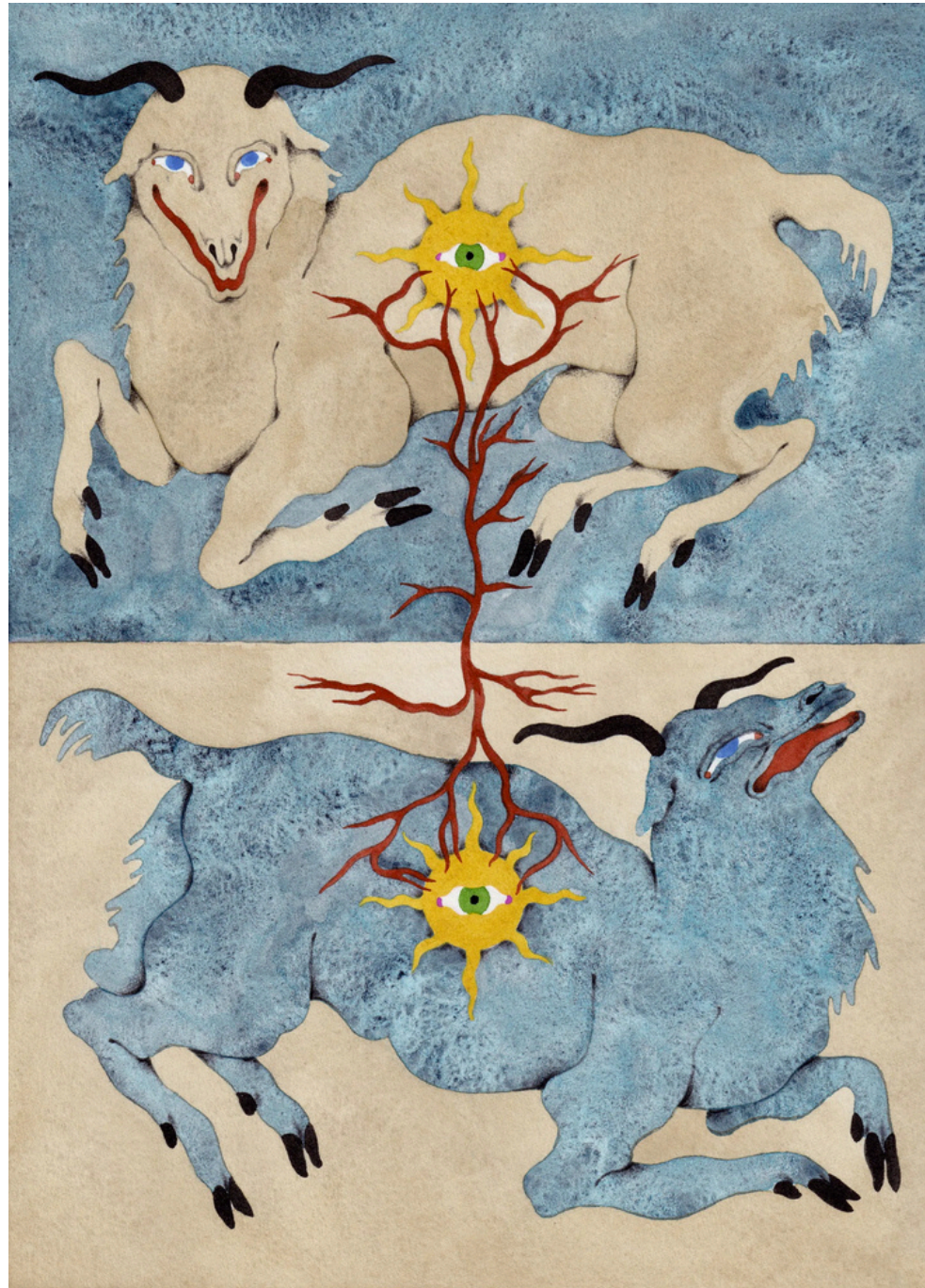


Lisbon, Portugal by Konstantinos Charisopoulos
2024; digital photography





Hey, my name is Shaurya and I am really really infatuated with the notion of creation. Irrespective of how one might perceive it, it should be a human tendency to keep nourishing newly bred ideas. Life is pretty miserable without the ability to correlate different hyperspaces and visions for me. I do enjoy fucking around every now and then.



The Shadow by Lou Benesch

2021; Watercolor, ink and colored pencil on paper

SCRIPTURES



EXPOSURES



PAINTED IN HIS IMAGE



A Prayer by Panagiotis Kouremenos

I ought to remain humble, when discussing poetry, for I have to keep in mind the minor relevance of me and my works, in front of her godsent, holy code or its absence thereof. Still, on nights like this I give in and create with my words what my heart really aches for: A consolation after a lonely evening, to remain away from what keeps me unfaithful, closer to what I deem as sacred and devote to. And I shall be devoted to you poetry, for to you I pray this inconsolable night. I can hear the

wind whispering your name, I can see you wearing the face of a lover, though it is really your face, in front of me apparent and alight, you are the most sacred part of a holy night, you are the wet rise of love and the thorny fall of separation. I am devoted wholly to you, you never escape my mind. Let me pray, for you to never cease flowing as a sentient showcase of love, to keep birthing this river that flows within me, for without it I am nothing but away from your warmth that graces your waters.

Bless me river, bless me faith, gift me with an abundance of nights like this night that I stand before you and pray, giving my whole faith to you. Nights like this are the greatest form of love that a man can enjoy, simultaneously being unborn and reborn.



Angel by Merab Abramishvili
2005; oil on linen plywood

Two Poems by Panagiotis Kouremenos

St. Stephen the Protomartyr

Be it my grievance to speak a word of truth?
Your hatred, wicked Judeans, fills your mouth and eyes,
And the rocks you throw, are not my demise,
For I will abandon not my faith.
On the dawn after Christ's crowning,
My death will be remembered through the eons,
Echoing your treacherous deeds.
But I forgave thee accordingly to the fable,
Before I drew my last breath,
For I followed the way of my Lord's parable.

The Swallow

The old wrinkled tree turned pale,
It fell as its leaves and branches failed,
Dropped acorn and slender twig,
And twig twisted, spat away fir cone and fig,
As the swallow cried its song of colorless spring,
Sung in meadow, heard in gallow.

It reached my ears on a morn,
I was silent and alone,
Solemn and nude, for you were absent,
Left me unaccompanied in solitude.
That morn, the earth gifted me fir cone and fig,
To bear the absence of my doorbell's ring.



De Astris et Argento by Jaro Kerschbaum

Of all the ways humanity has defiled the cosmos in its more recent endeavours, there is perhaps none quite as depressing as light pollution. The ancients, upon regarding the infinite vastness above them, believed the sparkling dots that filled the darkness to be angels and deities. The brightest star, the one that lit up the horizon to herald the dawn and again to usher in the night, was Love herself, the most luminous light in our earthly life. The Love that led us and gave us hope in the darkest epochs, comforting us and reminding us that just across the hill, beyond the horizon, lay a light, whose splendour our fantasies could yet not paint. She was accompanied by her husband, whose red hue declared him to be the god of blood, the drive of Thanatos ever jostling with his wife for supremacy over our souls. It was a terrifying world, but also one of beauty. Looking up to see that deep black sea with all its brilliant diamonds and the white street of Hera's milk behind them is enough to put one in awe, to remind man that he is but a rising ape, yet the closeness of these angels, thousands visible every night, the soft wall that allowed Orion and Cassiopeia to traverse, that permitted the Dragon and his demons to fall, is enough to inspire a man that there is more to life than toil, that greater beauty awaits, its immanence trumpeted from the skies above. Infinity was not just a theory, it lay up there, beckoning you to join, to swim in the sea of stars.

And now, consider our current heavens, a pale grey puddle compared to the richness of that ocean the ancients perceived. On fortunate nights we may see the sad wagging of the Bear's tail, if we are lucky, just before dawn, we may even see Venus, as our ancestors did. But she is no longer a goddess of love and beauty, instead an empty gaseous ball that runs around mindlessly in an empty space, pulled by powers stronger than her.



But all the rest has been swallowed by the city, an eldritch horror of our own making, sucking up the white beauty of the stars and leaving us only its own orange illumination. No longer are the lights in the sky radiating from gods and angels, they are made through the sweat of the labourer and the rape of Nature. Bones of reptiles dead for aeons now must be pulled from their graves to be burnt for us. There are no longer any gods above us, we have made our own and they are disgusting. Not terrifying or sublime in their otherness but mind-numbing and boring in their mundanity. Yes, we have killed God but unlike what Nietzsche hoped, we have not become gods, instead enslaving ourselves to the forces below us. Mammon and Leviathan have risen up from their hell to haunt us and we foolishly accepted their lordship, closing the door to the heavens, the gate to transcendent beauty, with a thick wall of smog and decrying the few phantoms still visible to be mere rocks. Above us is an emptiness mirroring that within us, everything is so close as to suffocate us and yet there is nothing to reach out to, no angels, no gods, no hope. We have subsumed every last hint of transcendence in the mundanity of a nine-to-five and a house in suburban purgatory.

And yet, on a cold night, when you drive out of the city, far from the lights of the towers and the noises of the cars, when we go up the mountains, through the forest and onto the meadow, the one only we know, we can lie down. Our heads cushioned on the soft grass, our bodies held by the soft embrace of gravity, we can look down upon that ancient ocean that preceded humanity. We can see the angels move as they sparkle, we point out chariots and archers, hunters and lovers. It is almost enough to make one believe.



Unrest by May Vakalaki

Poets don't go to heaven. They tremble in their graves, startling the murders of crows that peck at their remains. Unable to endure the tremors, they flutter away. The maggots that feed off of them spit them right out. The most notorious scavengers are found lacking against the bitter aftertaste of a poet's heart. Even in ashes they become stardust, forced to accompany the moon. The same moon under which they spent endless nights aching. Calling out on a dawn never to arrive. They turn to mist that envelopes the mountains and rainfalls that pour down like their eyes always used to. They become flowers stuck in an eternal cycle of withering and blooming.



Vanitas Still Life by Jan van Kessel the Elder
oil on copper, 1665-1670

Dim lit passage by May Vakalaki

I found the unseen pathway to the tranquil sea
And every day I stack stone after stone, I'd say I'm safe
The newly bought curtains imitate the shades of the plants
And the chamomile I brewed momentarily warms my insides
I stitch the wounds and patch together remedies to treat them
Strokes on the insides of my arms, softer than silken gauzes
The lighting low, the color of the sunset
But the worms under my skin have yet to flee
A loyalty I'd rather not cherish
A loyalty though that is guaranteed
And some days they crawl rapidly, relentlessly - the sensation of the
itch makes its way back
How can I get them out if not by ripping flesh
How can I fill the cavities they gift me in every place they chew on
How could you have never taught me what love is
The greediest of worms
Gnawed on my intestines, my core
Who is to blame if hands that roughly grip me feel comforting
Even more than tender affection does
And the mixture of pressure and possession creates a better painkiller
Ruptures and tears are what soothe the ache
Gluttony and feasts upon my figure feel right
Those ravenous creatures
If I can't remove them I'll let them devour me whole

Front-Line-Tactics,

The ooze of troops climbing out the hollow window
with faces plush as morning snow,
They watched the light's unending consumption.
To see one boy, among the crowd, watching me
His eyes, a valley; his shirt, summer sheets
hung in the wind.

I wondered what he thought of the war
off to the side. Probably as much as any
Missionary born with guiding ropes around his neck.
'You smell of sweat. Have you been running?' Asked I,
He replied, 'We do. We all have at one point
in life.' And when I closed my eyes
it came.

watching that light consume
a hill the troops were trawling upward
with all of them on it,
It brought to mind when I came visiting
by the hollow window of another foster place -
Roots all tangibly the same -
and whilst each rough-faced babe
was steeled, taught to face the sun,
I saw him staring back at me -
My father's hopeful eyes.

by Cameron McNaughton



Nepočin-polje by Joël Miguel Lädrach
2023; analog photography



Roma by Joël Miguel Lädrach
2023; digital photography



Last Meeting by Joël Miguel Lädrach
2024; digital photography





Untitled by Robin Reimann
2024; digital photography



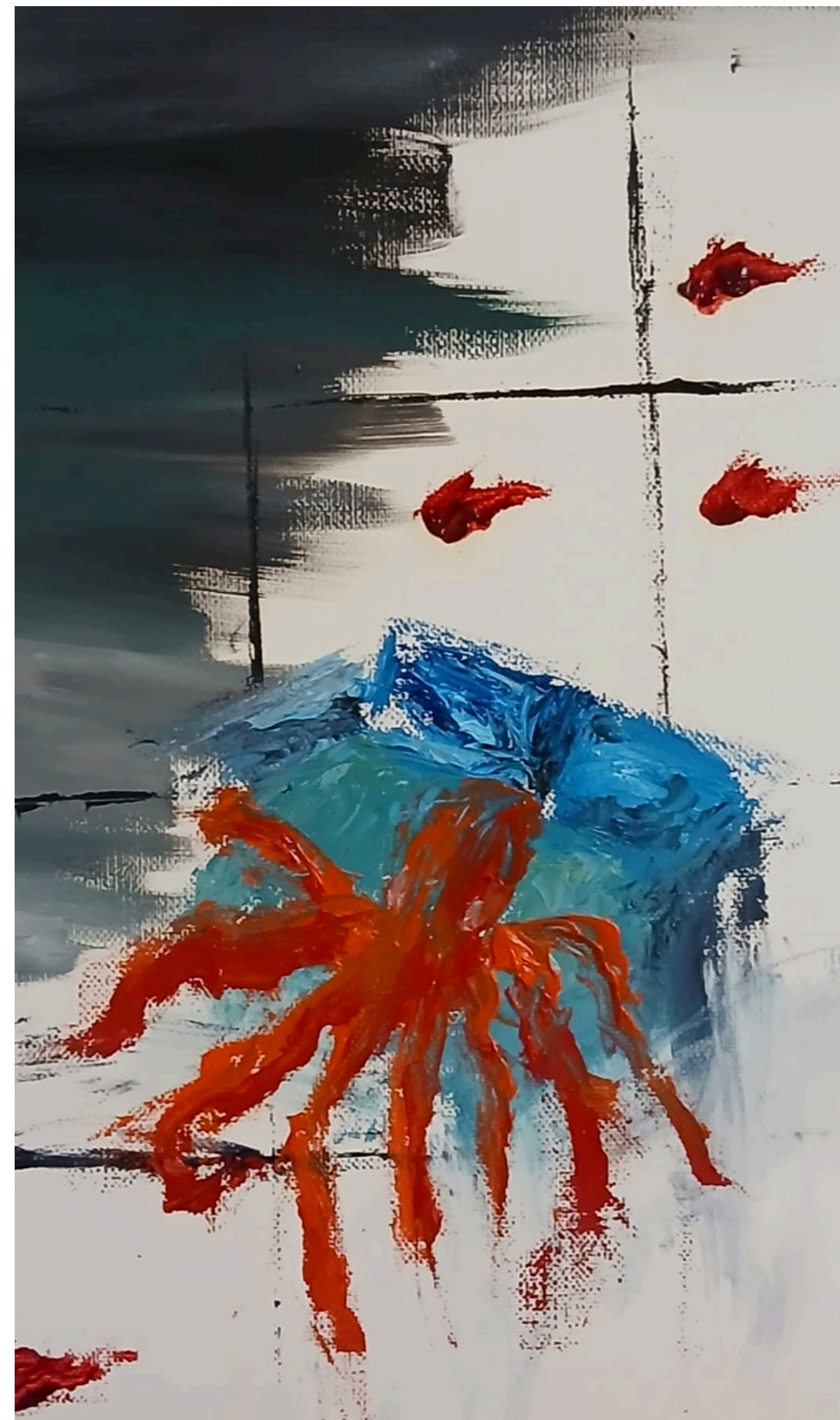
Blauer Reiter by Robin Reimann
2024; digital pinhole photography



Yun Soo-Ki from "Figures" series by Robin Reimann
2024; print/collage



Untitled by Robert Ken Hanke
2023; digital photography



Dinner without us by Charilaos
2024; oil on canvas





Rabbit Piece 1/3 by Jamie Daly
2021; mixed media



Rabbit Piece 3/3 by Jamie Daly
2022; mixed media



Rabbit Piece 2/3 by Jamie Daly
2022; oil on paper



Woman with Mask by Robert Ken Hanke
2024; acrylic on paper

IN QUESTION...

RANDALL'S INTERVIEW
WITH ROB AND
PANAGIOTIS



RANDALL: Gentlemen. How are we today? What was for breakfast?

ROB: Feeling very good! I had a protein shake this morning. Is this for the interview already? *[laughs]*

RANDALL: Yeah. *[laughs]*

ROB: Nice, I like it.

RANDALL: Panos?

PANAGIOTIS: Today has been good, much sunlight with a very beautiful sunrise we had this evening. I ate two loafs of peanut butter with a glass of almond milk this morning.

RANDALL: Almond milk is where it's at. My only milk is almond.

PANAGIOTIS: Very underrated if you ask me.

RANDALL: Very.

ROB: I have to stand my ground for the good old cow's milk.

PANAGIOTIS: I'm not a huge milk fan, but almond and chocolate milk are my two favorites.

RANDALL: I don't know about the U.K., but in Canada the dairy industry is cooked. I don't trust that cow's milk. It's dirty.

ROB: Thank God we have somewhat high standards in Germany when it comes to cleanness.

RANDALL: So, we said no small talk, but, since this congregation is happening from distance, we should clarify where we're from.

For reader's sake.

PANAGIOTIS: Good call, I am Panagiotis, and I am from Greece.



Inter artes et naturam by Pierre Puvis de Chavannes; 1890-1890; oil on canvas



ROB: Hello, my name is Rob and I'm from Germany.

RANDALL: Germany and Greece...How does this affect your art, the culture of these areas I mean? Because where I'm from, much of the things I see and the society formed around me, is where I draw my inspiration from.

PANAGIOTIS: Should I start? Or do you want to go at it, Rob?

ROB: Go on Panos.

RANDALL: Let's dive into it. Meanwhile, I am going to put on some music, since this interview is going to be a patient one. The soundtrack will be Miles Davis.

PANAGIOTIS: I would say my living has been (generally speaking) easy. My art has been affected the most by places I have a root connection with, I am thankful to be living in a place in Athens which has plenty of greenery and a great view of the city, once you walk up some hilly places. My art, I think, has always been "fragile", maybe vulnerable, because I keep thinking of my sickly days of youth, when I struggled heavily with asthma. So many lost days bedridden can awaken some deep part inside a man's soul, I believe, which wants nothing more than to see the world. I believe I want to see the world in its naked beauty, unaffected and alive. I think I somewhat lost this when I was

younger, although I am still in my early 20s. My poems are focused on nature a lot and that stems from a deep admiration for what this world has to offer to me. The thought of losing this treasure hidden in plain sight due to man's irresponsible and selfish actions, is something that scares me





RANDALL: I feel that. The nature around me has been declining, I think I noticed around late 2022 that things are definitively changing, which is something I can't control. It's like a tsunami that I have to ride, and it does scare me. There are indeed treasures in plain sight, which are being pillaged.

ROB: I think the circumstances of how you grow up will always influence you as a person and therefore the art you make. I had the privilege to grow up with two very different and unique cultures, which also share a lot of similarities, that is my German and my Japanese side. Books (yes, I grew up in an age without the internet), nature and religion have followed me my whole life and can be found in almost every single work.



Maple Trees
by Hasegawa
Tohaku - 1592,
ink, colour,
and gold on
paper

PANAGIOTIS: How can we be so ungrateful that we are willing to let the one thing that offers us inspiration, thirst for creation, and, well, life simply go? This is a cancer of modern man which he constantly avoids.

RANDALL: I think that the internet is a huge influence on me. I see it as both a tool, and a culture ripe for change and observation. You, Rob, run *sfpmagazine* on Instagram, so maybe you can relate.

PANAGIOTIS: Similar to Rob, I hadn't had direct connection to the internet up until 6 years ago. This avoidance of "the new age" can be impactful on how you see the world, you may stay behind on some cultural or societal norms, yes, but you develop your psyche.



RANDALL: I think I got my first iPad when I was 6, in 2011, and since then, I've been practically fused with the internet. Chronically, or at this point, terminally online, as they say.

PANAGIOTIS: It is one of the terms that fills me with some kind of dread, to think that a child might never experience a childhood similar to mine.

RANDALL: Well, I experienced a normal childhood, but the internet was always a part of it, as a tool of socializing. But yeah, other people were not as fortunate...It is definitely corrupting the youth.

ROB: Absolutely, the internet has shaped my taste and my view on art and basically any other topic in a way nothing else had before. Just the sheer number of possibilities is still something I can't fully grasp. My Instagram accounts were made, similarly to this magazine, out of the desire to talk about my interest and share my ideas.

RANDALL: Before you two started Pandora Magazine, Rob had been running *sfpmagazine* on Instagram. What inspired that, where did it come from, and how do you view it, now that it's become this pillar for archiving visual arts? It's a beautiful thing. I watched it grow into its 1400 or 1500 follower thing, still niche, but it commands a niche.

ROB: So, before *sfpmagazine*, I used to run a music account *music.sfp*. But at some point, I wanted to expand on that and create a platform to share all kinds of topics. To be honest, for me there is no deeper meaning behind it, I'm just happy to have an audience that likes the things I post and that I can discuss these with.

PANAGIOTIS: I discovered your page via another similar archive page and, I must say, I was dumbfounded at the way that the number of your posts matched their quality.

RANDALL: Yeah, that is insane to me.





ROB: Thank you for the compliment, but I think over the years that's kind of natural, you develop a sense of what's interesting and then fall into rabbit holes and find more and more.

RANDALL: But still, it requires a rare motivation. If either of you are familiar with *t.archivist*, also on Instagram, I see it similar to that.

PANAGIOTIS: Oh yeah, he is the mothership of archive pages (sorry Rob). [Rob laughs]. What I realized is that there is a huge unseen part of uncut culture that can be so easily found thanks to the internet.

RANDALL: 1000000%

RANDALL: How do these things you post impact you? Typically, when I decide to add something to my aesthetic, I'm thinking about the color and message of the image, and as a fan of art, and as an artist, I'm almost looking at other work with a type of reverence and deep appreciation that ties into myself as a person. It's hard to verbalize sometimes.

ROB: There is a motivation to find interesting things to a certain degree. Before *sfp magazine*, I did it for myself, now I'm just sharing my "treasures" with other like-minded people to enjoy.

RANDALL: You said it was not deeper than that, but there's passion in there.

ROB: Art as a whole is my passion.



Dominique Mercy in "Nelken (Carnations)" by Pina Bausch (1982)



RANDALL: Panos, or Panagiotis, is a very mysterious person. I don't know much about you, so I'll start with your routine. As an artist, I find my routine, my habits and schedule kind of guide who I am. It's almost spiritual, the things I practice, they feed my thought and being, even if it's something as inconsequential as going to the store. I'll take a certain route, for example. I'll buy something that specifically feeds me pleasure and inspiration. I like to have Arizona Iced Tea on hand, which I'm not sure if it's available in the U.K. I'm trying to understand what shapes Panos the person. Who is that person, habitually? Am I spelling your name right? I don't think I am.

PANAGIOTIS: First of all, yes, you are! Secondly, iced tea has been my favorite since I was young. Now as far as my habits go, I cannot describe myself better than with the phrase "left to my own devices". One day, I might feel like a very inferior "artist" that tries to create something to no avail, but on certain days, I feel as though I can write something that I want to no longer contain within me. I guess you could say I swing back and forth on procrastination and work ethic. But there is one certain day of the year, when on the last Sunday of every October something changes in my environment. I like to sit on my balcony and feel the weather change from autumn to winter, listen to jazz and write or draw anything that comes to mind. I usually treat myself with a glass of wine. I am always very organized that day, helping my parents, cleaning the whole house etc. etc...maybe it is me in my "ideal" form.

RANDALL: [laughs] That's real. I notice though that when I produce something, it's very charged. I flip flop between procrastinating and then it just explodes out of me.

ROB: Man, these questions are point on Randall!

RANDALL: I will not lie, I wrote most of these last minute. I'm a huge procrastinator.

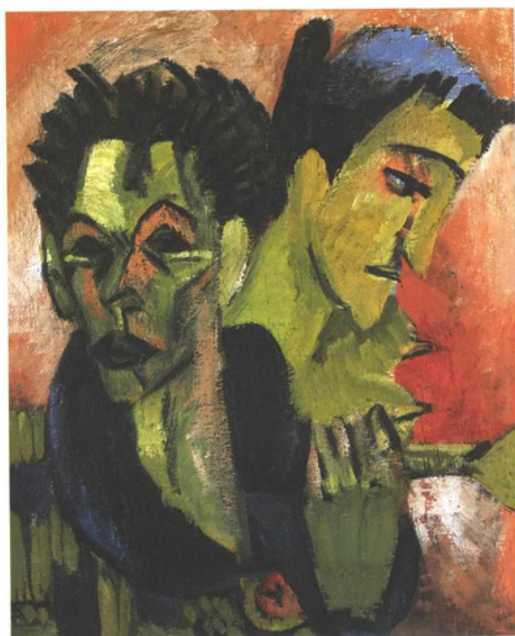




PANAGIOTIS: I like to pour emotion on my works as well, I would not like my art if it was like my everyday life. I think each person wants to show his inner world to the world, so what he or she or it does is making a work that is honest and made with love. Not many people write with honesty anymore.

RANDALL: We'll come back to this, because I actually do have something to say about that. I want to ask Rob about his process for painting, Panos, I also want to ask you something. But Rob, since you are a painter, what's that like for you? And do you find you're able to paint exactly what you see in your head? I notice that's a big thing for artists. And your paintings are abstract, almost childlike in a way, but with all that freedom in the form and color.

ROB: No, I have to be honest, I can't always paint what I have in mind, because I'm limited in my artistic ability. That's why I rely more on color and overall composition to make my paintings. Not being able to express myself properly has been a huge problem for me all my life though. I tried myself in all sort of artforms, but nothing seemed to really work. As for my process, there really isn't any. When the inspiration hits, I can paint for days without a break.



**Double Self-Portrait by
Ernst Ludwig Kirchner**
1915; oil on canvas

RANDALL: So, once it hits, it just kind of all flows out. Like you fall into the zone. That reminds me of what Basquiat said about his art as well. Or at least, I think he said something like that.

ROB: I have old sketches which portray me with a fountain of ideas pouring out of my head. Because that's how my brain feels like, 1000 ideas at once. But not many find their way outside.



RANDALL: Favorite painters, or visual artist? I wanted to mention Rothko, and impressionist art, because I find impressionism, and maybe expressionism, to be the most exciting corners of painting. Those colors are beautiful. I specifically love Cezanne and Matisse at the moment.

ROB: Great taste! Those are some of my favorites as well. My all-time favorite though is Picasso. I vividly remember picking up this book as a young kid and it featured "Guernica". A monumental piece portraying the bombing of the Basque city of Guernica in 1937. Even as a kid, it instantly hit me and I understood its message, moreover, it opened my eyes to what is possible, how you can compose a painting and how black and white is enough to make such a powerful piece. To this day, "Guernica" and Picasso's whole career as an artist is a source of inspiration.



**Guernica by
Pablo Picasso**
1937; oil on canvas

RANDALL: "Guernica" is the most mind-blowing painting. Something about the shape and just that image of those people. It's magnetic.

PANAGIOTIS: "Guernica" transcends painting in my opinion.

RANDALL: It's such a simple painting, at least from a distance.

ROB: Indeed, it is more than a painting.

RANDALL: But like you say it totally transcends that.

ROB: The agony and the pain of the victims has never been captured better and, especially in times like this, we should think about the horrors of war and all work together instead.





RANDALL: This one is more open ended: I find significance in daily situations, and also some weird shit just be happening. Like a month ago, I was at this breakfast diner, but it was like 2 AM. And I walked in and it was empty, except for this extremely, like extremely, overweight man who had a catheter with him and something going up his nose, and he was trying to pay for his meal, except the cashier was currently dealing with reserving a dinner for 20 people. For exactly 4:24 AM. That was some Twin Peaks shit, but it kind of stuck with me, how often all these weird elements of our lives can intersect and create just this weird space, where one comes to realize how weird humans are, with our little processes and idiosyncrasies. Whenever I get bored, I just think of how bizarre that experience was. And so, I'm wondering if there's any moment of relative, but weird, normality or mundanity we can speak on from our lives as of recent, to highlight these things.

PANAGIOTIS: This moment of your life was directed by David Lynch.

ROB: Speaking of Twin Peaks, what a masterpiece that is.

RANDALL: David Lynch as a whole is a masterpiece.

PANAGIOTIS: I am in the middle of the second season. David Lynch is one of my favs.



Twin peaks opening by David Lynch & Mark Frost (1990-1991)



RANDALL: So basically, are there any Lynchian moments as of late? Or just like anything normal that really stuck with y'all.

ROB: I have these weird moments from time to time. I woke up the other day and didn't feel like I was in my body, I felt that I was observing myself from outside. Suddenly, this feeling hit me that something terrible is about to happen. Then I thought, maybe I am viewing my death again, but now from an outside perspective.

PANAGIOTIS: That is terrifying.

RANDALL: Real.

PANAGIOTIS: But also, pretty rad.

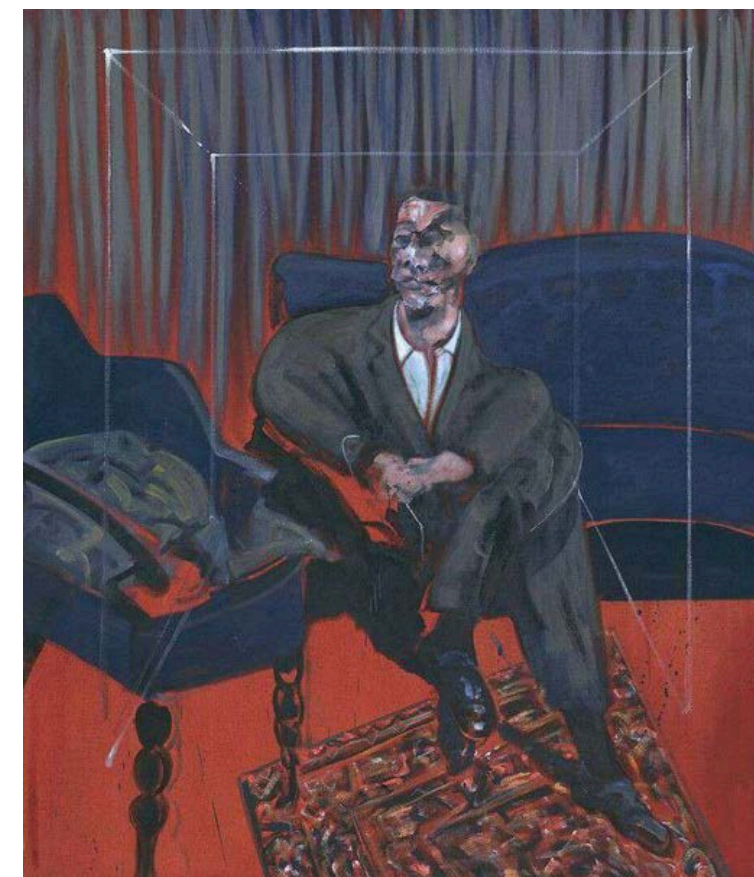
ROB: The next day it was back to normal. I should write a story about it. *[laughs]*

RANDALL: Sometimes I wake up, nay, most days I wake up like that. Just overwhelming dread and anxiety that takes me until like 1 PM to clear up. Sometimes, I just disappear into my head, and it takes me days to get out of it. Like I have to force myself.

PANAGIOTIS: I have a moment to include, although it is more on the religious cinema side of things.

RANDALL: Go ahead.

PANAGIOTIS: It was on the night of Great Saturday, which is a huge day for Greek Easter, because hordes of people go to the churches to celebrate Jesus Christ's rebirth. But this happened in my room, I was already good to go but



Seated Figure by Francis Bacon
1961; oil on canvas





waited for my parents to get ready. So, I was sitting in plain silence with an ochre light dimly lighting my room, outside it was absolutely quiet, not even the cicadas of my village could dare to break the silence. So, I was listening to the song "Wealth" by Talk Talk and trying to comprehend something that to this day I still cannot describe, but it was a wonderful feeling, like the world had stopped, turned to look inside itself and realized that it needed to look backwards to go forward. I consider myself lucky to have been born in a world where this can be a reality, especially given to me. I think that was my religious awakening.

RANDALL: That's an incredibly beautiful moment. I think those moments where it feels like the universe is imposing itself on you are important, which sounds pretentious, but I don't know how else to say it. Like where you exit a moment, and it's like you're inbetween scenes on a stage.

PANAGIOTIS: I would say that the universe came to a big convergence and sent this moment as a message.

ROB: Randall, you are a fantastic interviewer, I must say.

PANAGIOTIS: Yeah, these questions are off the charts.

RANDALL: I am humbled. Thank you. I think we could transition into music. I have one more question written down.

PANAGIOTIS: Drop it.

RANDALL: It shall arriveth on timeth. So, Rob, I saw that you posted a number of hip-hop songs on your story, what was that about?

ROB: My love for hip-hop, obviously! That's actually how I got into music in the first place. A friend was showing me Tupac, Biggie and Eminem and I just fell in love with it. I had never heard something so catchy but at the same time so insightful before. As time moved on, I expanded my knowledge and taste and currently I'm mainly listening to classical music. But sometimes you just want to bump some hip-hop.



RANDALL: Dude, I love hip-hop! That is my life and blood.

ROB: I think sometimes it doesn't get taken that seriously in the music community due to its accessibility and popularity. Especially in music elitist circles.

PANAGIOTIS: Sadly, many great verses that are being penned are also getting ignored.

ROB: My favorite lyricists are Kendrick Lamar, Earl Sweatshirt, the whole Wu-Tang Clan and also MF DOOM. They also have top tier production every single time.

PANAGIOTIS: I will come forth with a Greek one, it is called "Poutana Glamouria" by low bap group Vavilona. MF DOOM is my favorite rapper too.



MF DOOM with Tyler, the Creator and Earl Sweatshirt (2013)





RANDALL: Kendrick and Earl are in my top 3. Mr. Morale especially is excellent.

PANAGIOTIS: It is so good.

ROB: I will never forget how people were hating on Morale at first but now they love it. *[laughs]*

PANAGIOTIS: It exudes levels of melancholy binded to a verse and a beat.

RANDALL: Mr. Morale took me a long time to appreciate. It's a weird sounding album to me, but that's what I like about it.

ROB: It's not very conventional. It's truly fascinating how Kendrick has managed to bridge the gap between artistic genius and popularity to such a high degree.

RANDALL: The whole thing is strings and piano pretty much.

PANAGIOTIS: It is very personal, I think, and that is what elevates it. Its success lies, I believe, in its honesty.

RANDALL: What do we think? I think we got it! The interview.

ROB: Yeah, that was very enjoyable and some of the questions actually made me think, thank you!

RANDALL: What does Panos have to say?

PANAGIOTIS: I have to say that it was very, very fun and that I am lucky to have been part of this! Thank you, Randall, for the questions!

RANDALL: Alhamdulillah. It was a pleasure.



Authors Note

Initium est ilicet. Now that our intentions have been made manifest, you dear reader, art lover and enjoyer, can sit with your thoughts and weigh them, give them space to let them resonate deep in your intestines. You will soon realize, this is what humans that follow the path of artifice (it is you who are heavensent, it is you who are also treacherous) do, they walk a path where the goal is invisible to them until they have birthed it out of their inner world. This day and age has no time for pure demiurges, parthenogenesis is near extinct. Except in some caverns, where the digital world interconnects with this inherent desire of our souls, allowing fate to take form. Here is a wish: to create and to love your creation. An offering to things that make you daydream, to the warmth in your belly, to sheer awe, to art.

In the upcoming issue, when the gates to the garden of Pandora are opened again, revealing the lavish Eden which provides an altar for word, image and song, you, dear reader, shall expect more in-depth articles about the tiles of Lisbon, a firsthand pair of paintings and a secondhand pair of poems to accompany them, a dedication to a saint, interviews with fellow artists and even more works from the humble members of the magazine.



